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Exposure risk quantification

Abstract

The method comprises a first device recording audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device and performing a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data. The first device sends the first Fourier transform to the second device and receives a second Fourier transform of audio data recorded concurrently by the second device in response to the wireless proximity contact event. The first device, computes a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms and finding a maximum of the cross correlation that constitutes an exposure score. The first device compares the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other and outputs the exposure score and a binary threshold result.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to improve data collection and management, and more specifically to contact tracing utilizing wireless proximity detection.

(2) Contact tracing is a public health practice for identifying individuals who may have come into contact with a source of infectious disease. The goal of contact tracing is to isolate individuals who may be infected to prevent exposure of other individuals. Applications using mobile devices with wireless capabilities such as Bluetooth®, GPS tracking, and similar protocols have been developed

to track and notify individuals regarding potential exposure risks.

SUMMARY

(3) An illustrative embodiment provides a method for exposure risk quantification. The method comprises a first device recording audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device and performing a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data. The first device sends the first Fourier transform to the second device and receives a second Fourier transform of audio data recorded concurrently by the second device in response to the wireless proximity contact event. The first device, computes a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms and finding a maximum of the cross correlation that constitutes an exposure score. The first device compares the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other and outputs the exposure score and a binary threshold result. According to other illustrative embodiments, a computer system, and a computer program product for exposure risk quantification are provided.

(4) The features and functions can be achieved independently in various embodiments of the present disclosure or may be combined in yet other embodiments in which further details can be seen with reference to the following description and drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The novel features believed characteristic of the illustrative embodiments are set forth in the appended claims. The illustrative embodiments, however, as well as a preferred mode of use, further objectives and features thereof, will best be understood by reference to the following detailed description of an illustrative embodiment of the present disclosure when read in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 depicts a pictorial representation of a computing environment in which illustrative embodiments may be implemented;

(3) FIG. 2 depicts a block diagram for exposure risk quantification in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(4) FIG. 3 depicts an example of exposure risk quantification in a situation with high exposure in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(5) FIG. 4 depicts an example of exposure risk quantification in a situation with low exposure in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;

(6) FIG. 5 depicts an exposure quantification using audio likeness (EQUAL) analysis model in accordance with an illustrative embodiment; and

(7) FIG. 6 depicts a flowchart for exposure risk quantification in accordance with an illustrative embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Various aspects of the present disclosure are described by narrative text, flowcharts, block diagrams of computer systems and/or block diagrams of the machine logic included in computer program product (CPP) embodiments. With respect to any flowcharts, depending upon the technology involved, the operations can be performed in a different order than what is shown in a given flowchart. For example, again depending upon the technology involved, two operations shown in successive flowchart blocks may be performed in reverse order, as a single integrated step, concurrently, or in a manner at least partially overlapping in time.

(9) A computer program product embodiment (“CPP embodiment” or “CPP”) is a term used in the present disclosure to describe any set of one, or more, storage media (also called “mediums”) collectively included in a set of one, or more, storage devices that collectively include machine readable code corresponding to instructions and/or data for performing computer operations

specified in a given CPP claim. A “storage device” is any tangible device that can retain and store instructions for use by a computer processor. Without limitation, the computer readable storage medium may be an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, an electromagnetic storage medium, a semiconductor storage medium, a mechanical storage medium, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. Some known types of storage devices that include these mediums include: diskette, hard disk, random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), static random access memory (SRAM), compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disk (DVD), memory stick, floppy disk, mechanically encoded device (such as punch cards or pits/lands formed in a major surface of a disc), or any suitable combination of the foregoing. A computer readable storage medium, as that term is used in the present disclosure, is not to be construed as storage in the form of transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide, light pulses passing through a fiber optic cable, electrical signals communicated through a wire, and/or other transmission media. As will be understood by those of skill in the art, data is typically moved at some occasional points in time during normal operations of a storage device, such as during access, de-fragmentation or garbage collection, but this does not render the storage device as transitory because the data is not transitory while it is stored.

(10) With reference now to the figures, and in particular, with reference to FIG. 1, a diagram of a data processing environment is provided in which illustrative embodiments may be implemented. It should be appreciated that FIG. 1 is only meant as an example and are not intended to assert or imply any limitation with regard to the environments in which different embodiments may be implemented. Many modifications to the depicted environment may be made.

(11) FIG. 1 depicts a pictorial representation of a computing environment in which illustrative embodiments may be implemented. Computing environment **100** contains an example of an environment for the execution of at least some of the computer code involved in performing the inventive methods, such as exposure risk quantification **200**. In addition to exposure risk quantification **200**, computing environment **100** includes, for example, computer **101**, wide area network (WAN) **102**, end user device (EUD) **103**, remote server **104**, public cloud **105**, and private cloud **106**. In this embodiment, computer **101** includes processor set **110** (including processing circuitry **120** and cache **121**), communication fabric **111**, volatile memory **112**, persistent storage **113** (including operating system **122** and exposure risk quantification **200**, as identified above), peripheral device set **114** (including user interface (UI) device set **123**, storage **124**, and Internet of Things (IoT) sensor set **125**), and network module **115**. Remote server **104** includes remote database **130**. Public cloud **105** includes gateway **140**, cloud orchestration module **141**, host physical machine set **142**, virtual machine set **143**, and container set **144**.

(12) Computer **101** may take the form of a desktop computer, laptop computer, tablet computer, smart phone, smart watch or other wearable computer, mainframe computer, quantum computer, or any other form of computer or mobile device now known or to be developed in the future that is capable of running a program, accessing a network or querying a database, such as remote database **130**. As is well understood in the art of computer technology, and depending upon the technology, performance of a computer-implemented method may be distributed among multiple computers and/or between multiple locations. On the other hand, in this presentation of computing environment **100**, detailed discussion is focused on a single computer, specifically computer **101**, to keep the presentation as simple as possible. Computer **101** may be located in a cloud, even though it is not shown in a cloud in FIG. 1. On the other hand, computer **101** is not required to be in a cloud except to any extent as may be affirmatively indicated.

(13) Processor set **110** includes one, or more, computer processors of any type now known or to be developed in the future. Processing circuitry **120** may be distributed over multiple packages, for example, multiple, coordinated integrated circuit chips. Processing circuitry **120** may implement

multiple processor threads and/or multiple processor cores. Cache **121** is memory that is located in the processor chip package(s) and is typically used for data or code that should be available for rapid access by the threads or cores running on processor set **110**. Cache memories are typically organized into multiple levels depending upon relative proximity to the processing circuitry. Alternatively, some, or all, of the cache for the processor set may be located “off chip.” In some computing environments, processor set **110** may be designed for working with qubits and performing quantum computing.

(14) Computer readable program instructions are typically loaded onto computer **101** to cause a series of operational steps to be performed by processor set **110** of computer **101** and thereby effect a computer-implemented method, such that the instructions thus executed will instantiate the methods specified in flowcharts and/or narrative descriptions of computer-implemented methods included in this document (collectively referred to as “the inventive methods”). These computer readable program instructions are stored in various types of computer readable storage media, such as cache **121** and the other storage media discussed below. The program instructions, and associated data, are accessed by processor set **110** to control and direct performance of the inventive methods. In computing environment **100**, at least some of the instructions for performing the inventive methods may be stored in exposure risk quantification **200** in persistent storage **113**.

(15) Communication fabric **111** is the signal conduction path that allows the various components of computer **101** to communicate with each other. Typically, this fabric is made of switches and electrically conductive paths, such as the switches and electrically conductive paths that make up busses, bridges, physical input/output ports, and the like. Other types of signal communication paths may be used, such as fiber optic communication paths and/or wireless communication paths.

(16) Volatile memory **112** is any type of volatile memory now known or to be developed in the future. Examples include dynamic type random access memory (RAM) or static type RAM. Typically, volatile memory **112** is characterized by random access, but this is not required unless affirmatively indicated. In computer **101**, the volatile memory **112** is located in a single package and is internal to computer **101**, but, alternatively or additionally, the volatile memory may be distributed over multiple packages and/or located externally with respect to computer **101**.

(17) Persistent storage **113** is any form of non-volatile storage for computers that is now known or to be developed in the future. The non-volatility of this storage means that the stored data is maintained regardless of whether power is being supplied to computer **101** and/or directly to persistent storage **113**. Persistent storage **113** may be a read only memory (ROM), but typically at least a portion of the persistent storage allows writing of data, deletion of data, and re-writing of data. Some familiar forms of persistent storage include magnetic disks and solid state storage devices. Operating system **122** may take several forms, such as various known proprietary operating systems or open source Portable Operating System Interface-type operating systems that employ a kernel. Exposure risk quantification instructions included in block **200** typically includes at least some of the computer code involved in performing the inventive methods.

(18) Peripheral device set **114** includes the set of peripheral devices of computer **101**. Data communication connections between the peripheral devices and the other components of computer **101** may be implemented in various ways, such as Bluetooth® connections, Near-Field Communication (NFC) connections, connections made by cables (such as universal serial bus (USB) type cables), insertion-type connections (for example, secure digital (SD) card), connections made through local area communication networks, and even connections made through wide area networks such as the internet. In various embodiments, UI device set **123** may include components such as a display screen, speaker, microphone, wearable devices (such as goggles and smart watches), keyboard, mouse, printer, touchpad, game controllers, and haptic devices. Storage **124** is external storage, such as an external hard drive, or insertable storage, such as an SD card. Storage **124** may be persistent and/or volatile. In some embodiments, storage **124** may take the form of a quantum computing storage device for storing data in the form of qubits. In embodiments where

computer **101** is required to have a large amount of storage (for example, where computer **101** locally stores and manages a large database) then this storage may be provided by peripheral storage devices designed for storing very large amounts of data, such as a storage area network (SAN) that is shared by multiple, geographically distributed computers. IoT sensor set **125** is made up of sensors that can be used in Internet of Things applications. For example, one sensor may be a thermometer and another sensor may be a motion detector.

(19) Network module **115** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows computer **101** to communicate with other computers through WAN **102**. Network module **115** may include hardware, such as modems or Wi-Fi signal transceivers, software for packetizing and/or de-packetizing data for communication network transmission, and/or web browser software for communicating data over the internet. In some embodiments, network control functions and network forwarding functions of network module **115** are performed on the same physical hardware device. In other embodiments (for example, embodiments that utilize software-defined networking (SDN)), the control functions and the forwarding functions of network module **115** are performed on physically separate devices, such that the control functions manage several different network hardware devices. Computer readable program instructions for performing the inventive methods can typically be downloaded to computer **101** from an external computer or external storage device through a network adapter card or network interface included in network module **115**.

(20) WAN **102** is any wide area network (for example, the internet) capable of communicating computer data over non-local distances by any technology for communicating computer data, now known or to be developed in the future. In some embodiments, the WAN **102** may be replaced and/or supplemented by local area networks (LANs) designed to communicate data between devices located in a local area, such as a Wi-Fi network. The WAN and/or LANs typically include computer hardware such as copper transmission cables, optical transmission fibers, wireless transmission, routers, firewalls, switches, gateway computers, and edge servers.

(21) End user device (EUD) **103** is any computer system that is used and controlled by an end user (for example, a customer of an enterprise that operates computer **101**) and may take any of the forms discussed above in connection with computer **101**. EUD **103** typically receives helpful and useful data from the operations of computer **101**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **101** is designed to provide a recommendation to an end user, this recommendation would typically be communicated from network module **115** of computer **101** through WAN **102** to EUD **103**. In this way, EUD **103** can display, or otherwise present, the recommendation to an end user. In some embodiments, EUD **103** may be a client device, such as thin client, heavy client, mainframe computer, desktop computer and so on.

(22) Remote server **104** is any computer system that serves at least some data and/or functionality to computer **101**. Remote server **104** may be controlled and used by the same entity that operates computer **101**. Remote server **104** represents the machine(s) that collect and store helpful and useful data for use by other computers, such as computer **101**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **101** is designed and programmed to provide a recommendation based on historical data, then this historical data may be provided to computer **101** from remote database **130** of remote server **104**.

(23) Public cloud **105** is any computer system available for use by multiple entities that provides on-demand availability of computer system resources and/or other computer capabilities, especially data storage (cloud storage) and computing power, without direct active management by the user. Cloud computing typically leverages sharing of resources to achieve coherence and economics of scale. The direct and active management of the computing resources of public cloud **105** is performed by the computer hardware and/or software of cloud orchestration module **141**. The computing resources provided by public cloud **105** are typically implemented by virtual computing environments that run on various computers making up the computers of host physical machine set

142, which is the universe of physical computers in and/or available to public cloud **105**. The virtual computing environments (VCEs) typically take the form of virtual machines from virtual machine set **143** and/or containers from container set **144**. It is understood that these VCEs may be stored as images and may be transferred among and between the various physical machine hosts, either as images or after instantiation of the VCE. Cloud orchestration module **141** manages the transfer and storage of images, deploys new instantiations of VCEs and manages active instantiations of VCE deployments. Gateway **140** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows public cloud **105** to communicate through WAN **102**.

(24) Some further explanation of virtualized computing environments (VCEs) will now be provided. VCEs can be stored as “images.” A new active instance of the VCE can be instantiated from the image. Two familiar types of VCEs are virtual machines and containers. A container is a VCE that uses operating-system-level virtualization. This refers to an operating system feature in which the kernel allows the existence of multiple isolated user-space instances, called containers. These isolated user-space instances typically behave as real computers from the point of view of programs running in them. A computer program running on an ordinary operating system can utilize all resources of that computer, such as connected devices, files and folders, network shares, CPU power, and quantifiable hardware capabilities. However, programs running inside a container can only use the contents of the container and devices assigned to the container, a feature which is known as containerization.

(25) Private cloud **106** is similar to public cloud **105**, except that the computing resources are only available for use by a single enterprise. While private cloud **106** is depicted as being in communication with WAN **102**, in other embodiments a private cloud may be disconnected from the internet entirely and only accessible through a local/private network. A hybrid cloud is a composition of multiple clouds of different types (for example, private, community or public cloud types), often respectively implemented by different vendors. Each of the multiple clouds remains a separate and discrete entity, but the larger hybrid cloud architecture is bound together by standardized or proprietary technology that enables orchestration, management, and/or data/application portability between the multiple constituent clouds. In this embodiment, public cloud **105** and private cloud **106** are both part of a larger hybrid cloud.

(26) The illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account that Bluetooth® based contact detection is a simple way of determining whether the people carrying those devices have come into contact. In recent years, Bluetooth® has been used for contact tracing during the COVID-19 Pandemic. However, Bluetooth® was designed to connect stably under as many adverse conditions as possible, such as through walls, or at substantial range. As such, transmission of a Bluetooth® signal is generally easier than that of airborne pathogens. This aspect of Bluetooth® recently led to a “pingdemic” wherein large numbers of false positive alerts were sent by contact tracing due to people being in proximity enough for Bluetooth® to flag them, despite substantial other barriers (e.g., walls) in place protecting them from the pathogen. Examples included those living in apartments/flats, where Bluetooth® can pass between all the occupants of the building, but airborne pathogens cannot pass through walls.

(27) The illustrative embodiments also recognize and take into account that slightly more advanced systems use Bluetooth® for ranging as well, which can partially reduce false positives, only flagging positive when people are particularly close, but the issue of not recognising solid barriers remains an issue.

(28) The illustrative embodiments also recognize and take into account that false positives can carry a considerable cost. For example, false positives are estimated to have cost the UK economy £4.6 billion in one month where stringent isolation rules were to be followed after being “pinged.” Similar issues can occur worldwide with great impact if implemented the same way and can have far greater impacts if there is no means to advise isolation at all, such as in the absence of automated track and trace services.

(29) The illustrative embodiments provide exposure risk quantification that enhances Bluetooth® based contact detection to overcome the issues noted above and reduce false positives while increasing confidence in contact tracing systems. The illustrative embodiments determine exposure between users of devices by comparing characteristics of audio data recorded concurrently by the devices in response to a wireless proximity triggering event. Devices separated by a substantial physical barrier such as a wall will record audio with significantly different characteristics.

(30) FIG. 2 depicts a block diagram for exposure risk quantification in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Exposure risk quantification **200** can be implemented in computing environment **100** in FIG. 1.

(31) Exposure risk quantification **200** is triggered by a wireless proximity contact event **202** between two devices. The wireless contact might be established via Bluetooth®, Near-Field Communications (NFC) or similar short-range wireless communications protocols. The wireless proximity contact event **202** triggers an audio recording **204**, which occurs concurrently in the two devices. The audio recording comprises multiple constituent frequencies **206**. These constituent frequencies **206** are described by a Fourier transform **208** that is performed by both devices.

(32) The devices exchange Fourier transforms **208** and independently calculate a cross correlation **210** between the transforms. From there, a correlation maximum **212** is found. This correlation maximum constitutes an exposure score **214** between the devices (and their users/bearers).

(33) The exposure score **214** is compared to a threshold **216** to generate a binary result **218**. The binary result **218** denotes whether or not the devices have come into unacceptable contact with each other. Based on the exposure score **214** and binary result **218**, business logic **220** might be triggered to implement specific notifications and/or policies.

(34) FIGS. 3 and 4 depict contrasting examples of situations in which devices (and by extension their users) are the same distance from each other but have significantly different exposure risks.

(35) FIG. 3 depicts an example of exposure risk quantification **200** in a situation with high exposure in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. In this example, mobile phones **302**, **304** are located five meters apart in the same room.

(36) When the mobile phones **302**, **304** come within specific proximity range they trigger a Bluetooth® contact event **306**. This Bluetooth® contact event **306** triggers respective audio recordings **308**, **310** by both mobile phones **302**, **304**.

(37) The mobile phones **302**, **304** exchange Fourier transforms of their respective audio recordings **308**, **310** such that each device is able to analyze both Fourier transforms. The mobile phones **302**, **304** perform independent analyses **312**, **314** (see FIG. 5) based on the Fourier transforms to arrive at an exposure score **316**. The exposure score **320** can be expressed as a value between 0 and 1. In the present example, the similarities in acoustic characteristics of the two audio recordings **308**, **310** produce an exposure score of 1, indicating that the mobile phones **302**, **304** (and their respective users) are in the same room and in close enough proximity to constitute high exposure.

(38) FIG. 4 depicts an example of exposure risk quantification **200** in a situation with low exposure in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. In this example, mobile phones **402**, **404** are located five meters apart but in separate rooms.

(39) The principles of operation are the same as in FIG. 3. A Bluetooth® contact event **406** triggers respective audio recordings **408**, **410** by both mobile phones **402**, **404**. Though mobile phones **402** and **404** are separated by the same distance as phones **302** and **304** in FIG. 3, being in separate rooms on either side of wall **418** results in significant differences in audio recordings **408**, **410**. These differences are the result of different environmental factors in the rooms such as, e.g., background noises, furniture, etc., that make the respective acoustic characteristics of each room different from the other.

(40) As in FIG. 3, the mobile phones **402**, **404** exchange Fourier transforms of their respective audio recordings **408**, **410** and perform their own independent analyses **412**, **414** to arrive at an exposure score **416**. In the present example, the differences in acoustic characteristics of the two

audio recordings **408**, **410** produce an exposure score of 0, indicating that the mobile phones **402**, **404** (and their respective users) are in different rooms and therefore have low exposure to each other.

(41) FIG. 5 depicts an exposure quantification using audio likeness (EQUAL) analysis model in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. EQUAL model **500** represented the analytical framework used by the devices participating the exposure quantification. A Bluetooth® contact event **510** triggers concurrent audio recordings **502** on both devices. The devices take these concurrent audio recordings **502** and calculate the corresponding Fourier transforms **504** to extract the time series frequency content of the audio data. A Fourier transform decomposes a signal into its constituent frequencies by taking a time-domain representation of the signal and converting it into a frequency-domain representation. Each device performs a Fourier transform on its audio recording and sends it to the other device. For security applications, the Fourier transforms **504** can be obfuscated and/or one way. After the Fourier transform, the original audio recordings **502** can be deleted to comply with security and/or privacy policies.

(42) Using both Fourier transforms **504**, each device can independently computer a cross correlation **506** of the Fourier data. After computation of the cross correlation **506**, the Fourier transforms **504** may also be deleted.

(43) The cross correlation **506** provides a similarity score over varying time offsets of the two audio recordings **502**. From there, the devices identify maximum **508** of the cross correlation using methods such as gradient ascent, simulated annealing, etc. This maximum becomes the exposure score **512** (between 0 and 1).

(44) EQUAL model **500** creates a score **512** that inversely correlates the extent of audio attenuation and disruption between two devices. This score can be combined with the Bluetooth® proximity score to identify not only proximity but also the likelihood of sharing the same air. For example, the carriage of sound waves can act as an analogue to the carriage of pathogens.

(45) The exposure score **512** can be thresholded to determine whether or not the users of the devices have come into unacceptable contact with each other. The resulting output is a tuple comprising the exposure score **512** (between 0 and 1) and a binary threshold result. Business logic such as track and trace services can be triggered based upon the outcome of the thresholding and/or exposure score.

(46) The model and processing steps of the illustrative embodiments can be generalized and applied to a variety of proximity, locating, or security contexts. For example, the illustrative embodiments can be deployed as a countermeasure to provide eavesdropping warnings, provide accurate and/or less expensive room occupancy monitoring, as well as other applications that benefit from identifying physical barriers in addition to basic radio frequency (RF) detection. The illustrative embodiments can improve the sensitivity and accuracy of safety and security systems both within and outside the workplace, producing more concise and meaningful notifications.

(47) FIG. 6 depicts a flowchart for exposure risk quantification in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Process **600** can be carried out in computing environment **100** in FIG. 1.

(48) Process **600** begins by a first device recording audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device (step **602**). Examples of such devices include mobile devices, mobile phones, smart watches, laptop computers, tablet computers, desktop computers, and fixed base stations.

(49) The first device performs a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data (step **604**). In performing the Fourier transform, the first device might divide the audio data into lower resolution time intervals, wherein each time interval is integrated over time such that the Fourier transform is irreversible. For example, the Fourier transform might be averaged over intervals of one second rather than instantaneously. Optionally, the first device might delete the recorded audio data after performing the first Fourier transforms (step **606**).

(50) The first device sends the first Fourier transform to the second device (step **608**) and receives a

second Fourier transform from the second device of audio data recorded by the second device concurrently with the first device in response to the wireless proximity contact event (step **610**). Either or both devices might remove a subset of frequency bands from the respective Fourier transforms before sending the Fourier transforms to each other.

(51) The first device computes a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms (step **612**) and finds a maximum of the cross correlation, wherein the maximum constitutes an exposure score (step **614**).

(52) The first device compares the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other (step **616**). If the exposure score is below the threshold (e.g., because there is a wall separating the devices) the users are deemed not to be unacceptably exposed to each other (step **624**). If the exposure score exceeds the threshold the users of the first and second devices are deemed to have unacceptable exposure to each other (step **618**).

(53) Optionally, responsive to a determination that the users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other and that the devices are still in wireless proximity contact (step **620**), the first device might repeat the steps **604** through **614** at specified time intervals (e.g., every 10 seconds) as long as the first device and second device remain in wireless proximity contact, wherein a previous exposure score is added to a subsequent exposure score with each iteration (step **622**).

(54) The first device output the exposure score and a binary threshold result (step **626**). Optionally, the output might trigger business logic based on at least one of the exposure score or threshold result (step **628**). For example, the business logic might report to a track and tracing service that can be referenced at a later time, e.g., to help distribute medication in cases of pathogen exposure. As another example, the business logic might trigger a notification on a device, whether the same device involved in recording and comparing audio or another device used by the other. Process **600** then ends.

(55) As used herein, a “number of,” when used with reference to objects, means one or more objects. For example, a “number of different types of networks” is one or more different types of networks.

(56) Further, the phrase “at least one of,” when used with a list of items, means different combinations of one or more of the listed items can be used, and only one of each item in the list may be needed. In other words, “at least one of” means any combination of items and number of items may be used from the list, but not all of the items in the list are required. The item can be a particular object, a thing, or a category.

(57) For example, without limitation, “at least one of item A, item B, or item C” may include item A, item A and item B, or item B. This example also may include item A, item B, and item C or item B and item C. Of course, any combinations of these items can be present. In some illustrative examples, “at least one of” can be, for example, without limitation, two of item A; one of item B; and ten of item C; four of item B and seven of item C; or other suitable combinations.

(58) As used herein, a “computer instruction,” or “computer program”, means one step or a set of steps that includes information on how to operate, perform, or maintain particular computer software or hardware. For example, a “computer instruction” can be a computer program instruction in the form of lines of code or source code that are executable by a computer system.

(59) The description of the different illustrative embodiments has been presented for purposes of illustration and description and is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments in the form disclosed. The different illustrative examples describe components that perform actions or operations. In an illustrative embodiment, a component can be configured to perform the action or operation described. For example, the component can have a configuration or design for a structure that provides the component an ability to perform the action or operation that is described in the illustrative examples as being performed by the component. Further, to the extent that terms “includes”, “including”, “has”, “contains”, and variants thereof are used herein, such terms are

intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprises” as an open transition word without precluding any additional or other elements.

(60) The descriptions of the various embodiments of the present disclosure have been presented for purposes of illustration but are not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments disclosed. Not all embodiments will include all of the features described in the illustrative examples. Further, different illustrative embodiments may provide different features as compared to other illustrative embodiments. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the described embodiment. The terminology used herein was chosen to best explain the principles of the embodiment, the practical application or technical improvement over technologies found in the marketplace, or to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the embodiments disclosed here.

Claims

1. A method of exposure risk quantification, the method comprising: recording, by a first device, audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device; performing, by the first device, a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data; sending, by the first device, the first Fourier transform to the second device; receiving, by the first device, a second Fourier transform from the second device, wherein the second Fourier transform is of audio data recorded by the second device concurrently with the first device in response to the wireless proximity contact event; computing, by the first device, a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms; finding, by the first device, a maximum of the cross correlation, wherein the maximum constitutes an exposure score; comparing, by the first device, the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other; and outputting, by the first device, the exposure score and a binary threshold result.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising deleting the recorded audio data after performing the Fourier transform.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising removing, by the first device, a subset of frequency bands from the first Fourier transform before sending the first Fourier transform to the second device.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising dividing, by the first device, the audio data into lower resolution time intervals, wherein each time interval is integrated over time such that the first Fourier transform is irreversible.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the first device comprises at least one of: mobile devices; mobile phones; smart watches; laptop computers; tablet computers; desktop computers; or fixed base stations.
6. The method of claim 1, further comprising, responsive to a determination that users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other, recalculating, by the first device, the exposure score at specified time intervals as long as the first device and second device remain in wireless proximity contact, wherein a previous exposure score is added to a subsequent exposure score with each iteration.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising triggering business logic based on at least one of the exposure score or threshold result.
8. A system for exposure risk quantification, the system comprising: a first device with persistent storage to store program instructions; one or more respective processors on the first device, wherein the processors are operably connected to the respective persistent storage and configured to execute the program instructions to cause the first device to: record audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device; perform a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data; send the first Fourier transform to the second device; receive a second Fourier transform from the second device, wherein the second Fourier transform is of audio data recorded

by the second device concurrently with the first device in response to the wireless proximity contact event; compute a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms; find a maximum of the cross correlation, wherein the maximum constitutes an exposure score; compare the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other; and output the exposure score and a binary threshold result.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the program instructions further cause the first device to delete the recorded audio data after performing the first Fourier transform.

10. The system of claim 8, wherein the program instructions further cause the first device to remove a subset of frequency bands from the first Fourier transform before sending the first Fourier transform to the second device.

11. The system of claim 8, wherein the program instructions further cause the first device to divide the audio data into lower resolution time intervals, wherein each time interval is integrated over time such that the Fourier transform is irreversible.

12. The system of claim 8, wherein the first devices comprises at least one of: mobile devices; mobile phones; smart watches; laptop computers; tablet computers; desktop computers; or fixed base stations.

13. The system of claim 8, wherein the program instructions further cause the first device, responsive to a determination that users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other, to recalculate the exposure score at specified time intervals as long as the first device and second device remain in wireless proximity contact, wherein a previous exposure score is added to a subsequent exposure score with each iteration.

14. The system of claim 8, wherein the program instructions further cause the first device to trigger business logic based on at least one of the exposure score or threshold result.

15. A computer program product for exposure risk quantification, the computer program product comprising: persistent storage media on a first device, wherein the persistent storage media has program instructions configured to cause one or more processors on the first device to: record audio data responsive to a wireless proximity contact event with a second device; perform a first Fourier transform on the recorded audio data; send the first Fourier transform to the second device; receive a second Fourier transform from the second device, wherein the second Fourier transform is of audio data recorded by the second device concurrently with the first device in response to the wireless proximity contact event; compute a cross correlation of the Fourier transforms; find a maximum of the cross correlation, wherein the maximum constitutes an exposure score; compare the exposure score to a specified threshold that determines whether or not users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other; and output the exposure score and a binary threshold result.

16. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the program instructions further cause the processors to delete the recorded audio data after performing the first Fourier transform.

17. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the program instructions further cause the processors to remove a subset of frequency bands from the first Fourier transform before sending the first Fourier transforms to the second device.

18. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the program instructions further cause the processors to divide the audio data into lower resolution time intervals, wherein each time interval is integrated over time such that the first Fourier transform is irreversible.

19. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the program instructions further cause the processors to, responsive to a determination that users of the first and second devices have had unacceptable exposure to each other, recalculate the exposure score at specified time intervals as long as the first device and second device remain in wireless proximity contact, wherein a previous exposure score is added to a subsequent exposure score with each iteration.

20. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the program instructions further cause the processors to trigger business logic based on at least one of the exposure score or threshold result.

